The Slingshot Ad Strategy

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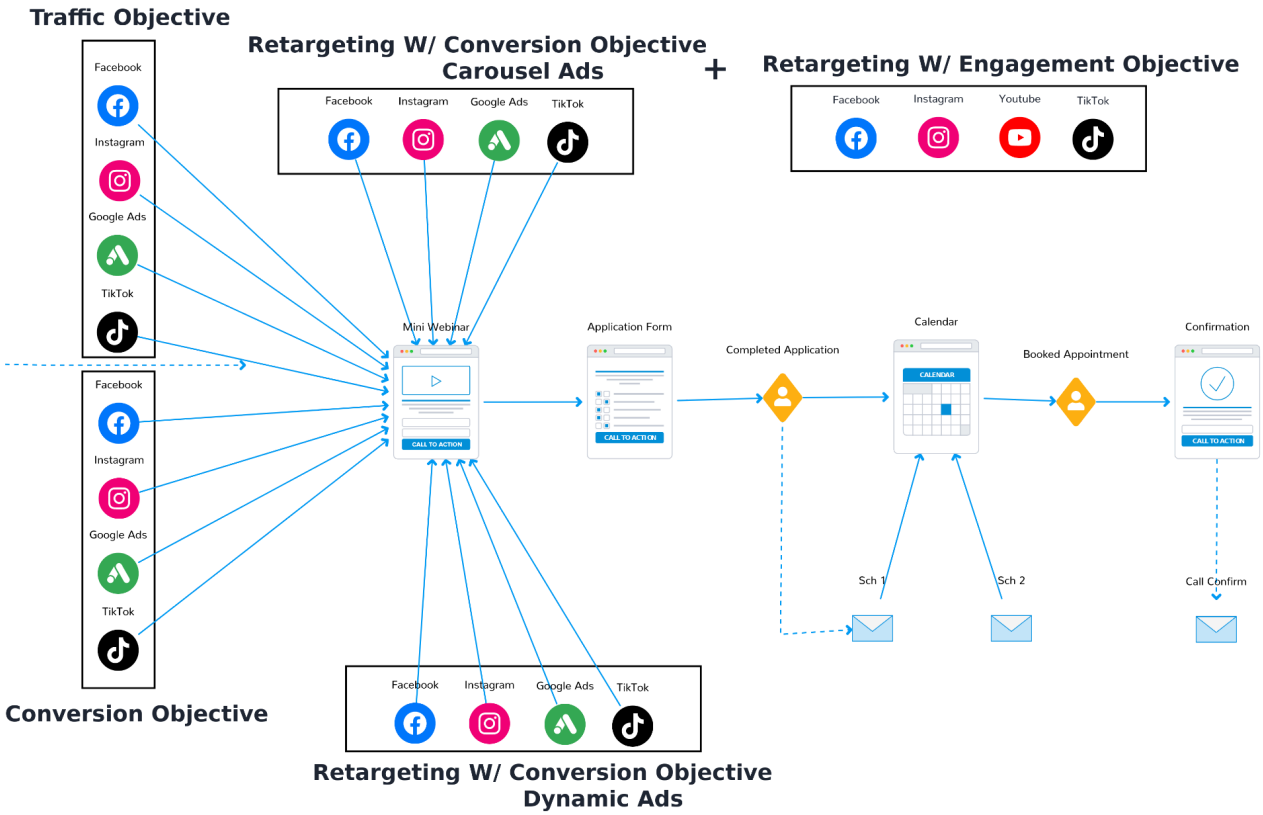

Haynes of Megalodon Marketing

Made For...

Ecommerce stores, personal brands selling info products, service businesses generating leads, and any business that has high CPMs, low CTR and low conversions on their front end conversion campaigns.

How it works:

With recent IOS 14 & 15 changes, the advertising game that marketers were used to playing has changed.

Whether your account is experiencing unusually high CPMs, little to no data reporting back into your results column within the ads manager, or just having bloated cost per

results from a mix of variables, The Slingshot ad strategy can help to bring down your cost per result and CPMs.

Most advertisers who have benefited from my Content First Advertising Strategies understand that if we start our campaigns off with content rather than direct response, we can benefit from substantially lower CPMs and cost per results following that system.

The Slingshot is similar to these strategies in the sense our goal is to substantially lower our CPM costs and drive up conversion quantities while lowering our CPA (cost per actions).

The Slingshot starts with two types of campaigns, a traffic objective optimized campaign and a conversion optimized campaign that are packed with direct response ads.

The traffic objective substantially lowers the cost per click and the CPMs of getting qualified traffic to your site while at the same time substantially increasing the unique link click through % rate to your page.

Traffic objectives also will drastically increase the number of people that visit your site for the same money spent as a conversion campaign.

Example:

- $100 spent on conversion campaign might result in 30-90 people clicking through to your site
- $100 spent on traffic objective campaign might result in 200-500 people clicking through to your site

The problem with the traffic campaigns is they typically send traffic to your site out of everyone that you're targeting that is probable to click, but not probable to convert, which results in a majority of advertisers ignoring the objective entirely.

Whereas conversion objectives are a prediction machine. With the tens of thousands of data points all of the major advertising platforms hold on each individual user, and based on the standard event objective you've selected on your conversion campaign to optimize for, the ad channel essentially predicts out of everyone you're targeting who would be the most probable to convert.

At that point, a small subset of the entirety of your audience you're attempting to target is shown the ads you've packed into your campaign to see if the people the ad channels deems probable to convert end up taking that action you're optimizing your campaigns for.

Historically conversion campaigns have worked extremely well, however with the new limitations in data reporting back into the ads managers this system is somewhat broken depending on your account and tracking set up.

This calls for a new approach to ensure we get high amounts of conversions daily and low CPAs (cost per action).

In The Slingshot you're setting up 2 sets of campaigns, one is optimized for traffic, and one is optimized for conversions. We do this to ensure we have profitability rather than trying to be right.

Campaign 1 is the traffic objective, optimized for CBO (campaign budget optimization) with 2-4 ad sets targeting whoever you would normally target with a conversion objective. Ideally you're also using dynamic ads and loading them up with 3-5 videos or images (preferably videos), 2-3 headlines, and 2-3 body copy variations in total.

Also within your traffic campaign on the ad set or ad group level be sure to select landing page views towards the bottom of the page rather than optimizing it for link clicks.

You're then going to duplicate out the traffic campaign and change the campaign optimization objective from traffic to conversions for the 2nd campaign. Make sure you then go to the ad set or ad group level and select the standard event you want to optimize your conversion campaign for.

The conversion campaign should be targeting the same audiences and have the same creative, it should also be driving traffic straight to the same page as the traffic objective.

You'll then want to make sure you have a few different audiences set up so you can create the next steps in the strategy. Head over to the audience section of your ads manager and create an all website visitors in the last 180 days audience, all ad button clicks for 365 days, and all ad video viewers over 10 seconds for the ads you've put into the traffic and conversion objective.

Also create an audience of the conversions so you can exclude it within all the campaigns within this strategy set up.

This gives you 3 audiences that are essentially unconverted web traffic of qualified potential buyers or leads that you are now going to retarget.

The next part of the Slingshot is you setting up the retargeting components of the strategy.

Create a conversion campaign optimized for whatever standard event you want to use, use CBO (campaign budget optimization) and on the ad set level, select all of those 3 audiences we just created in the previous step.

- Unconverted web traffic 180 days
- Ad button clicks 365 days
- 10 second video viewers of the ad videos in conversion & traffic campaign 365d

Make sure you have dynamic creative selected in this first retargeting set up. Load it up with whatever you would normally put into your retargeting campaigns. I like to use testimonials, objection handling videos, product explainer videos, unboxing videos, User Generated Content (UGC), problem agitate solve, us vs them ads, ease of use, lifestyle videos, or attention interest desire action.

Once your first retargeting campaign is published, go ahead and duplicate for a 2nd conversion retargeting campaign, this one should target the same unconverted audiences from the first retargeting campaign but rather than dynamic creative we are going to leverage carousel ads.

If you're an ecom store you can use the dynamic product catalog ads objective for this one rather than the conversion objective so you have the products the unconverted buyer previously went and viewed that will show in their feed using this objective.

Once you're newly duplicate retargeting campaign is created, go to the ad set level and make sure you turn off dynamic creative. Then go to the ad level and select carousel as the ad format rather than the single creative option.

For these retargeting carousel ads you'll want to load it up with two types of carousel ads. One carousel should be all testimonials, feel free to load up to 10 all together using all the tiles available.

Then duplicate that carousel ad so you end up with two ads within your single ad set, and change the creative in the 2nd carousel to be objective handling videos. These can include unboxing videos, product demonstration videos, ease of use videos, what the products made out of (quality, ethically source materials, etc), this can also be videos handling the common objectives your business faces.

Same logic, feel free to add up to 10 carousel videos into the tiles if they are available to you.

At this point you should have 4 campaigns created:

1. Traffic campaign
2. Conversion campaign
3. Retargeting conversion campaign with dynamic ads
4. Retargeting conversion campaign with carousel ads

You now have one final campaign that you need to create, and it should be a retargeting campaign optimized for engagement as the objective.

The ad set or ad group within this retargeting campaign should be targeting the same retargeting audiences as the other two retargeting campaigns you've set up.

This will use CBO, it will contain the one retargeting ad set, and it will not use dynamic creative, instead it will have 3-5 unique pieces of content that are posted to your FB, IG, Youtube or Tik Tok page to be selected as an 'existing post' to run in front of your unconverted traffic.

Ideally these 3-5 retargeting videos that you select have no call to action, they will have no click to anywhere, they are simply content that we are going to put in front of your unconverted audience. These videos should help to sell people your brand is an authority, that you have a customer base that is happy and using your product and loving it, and lastly overcoming any objections or potential unanswered questions that would be holding them back from buying.

Here's some examples:

- UGC (user generated content)
- Problem agitate solve
- Us Vs them
- testimonial

- demonstration
- ease of use
- unboxing
- carousel
- product photos with white background
- lifestyle photos
- lifestyle video
- attention interest desire action

Heres some common funnels that have been proven to work successfully with The Slingshot ad strategy:

1. Free + Shipping
2. Book Funnel
3. Mini Webinar
4. Webinar
5. Application Funnel
6. Ecom Sites (whether to direct site or product page)
7. Local service providers
8. Realtors (selling homes)
9. Lead magnets

Here's the ideal daily budget per campaign you should start at:

Traffic Campaign: $100/day

Conversion Campaign: $100/day

Retargeting Campaign - Dynamic Creative: $25-$50/day

Retargeting Campaign - Carousel Creative: $25-$50/day

Retargeting Campaign - Content / Engagement: $25-$50/day

Total: $350/day

<u>Do not launch this strategy with less daily budget than the above to see success with it.**</u>**

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